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SUN-PROTECTIVE GARMENT WITH STRETCH INDICATOR

Provisional patent specification

Applicant and inventor: Aaron Steele

FIELD

This invention relates to fit indicators for sun-protective garments.

BACKGROUND

Garments of stretch fabric are sold with an ultraviolet protection rating measured with the fabric relaxed. Extension of the fabric opens its structure and reduces the protection. A garment that has become too small for its wearer is extended in wear, and nothing on the garment indicates this.

SUMMARY OF THE INVENTION

In one aspect the invention provides: a sun-protective garment of stretchable fabric having an ultraviolet protection rating in a relaxed state, and a printed indicator on a region of the garment subject to stretch when worn. The indicator comprises printed elements separated by gaps that are visually closed in the relaxed state and visually open when the fabric is extended beyond a predetermined amount, the predetermined amount corresponding to an extension at which the protection of the fabric falls below a stated rating.

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWING

Figure 1 shows the indicator in two states: on the left with the fabric relaxed, appearing solid; on the right with the fabric extended, appearing striped.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

The indicator is printed on the relaxed fabric as a set of parallel bars with narrow gaps, together forming a recognisable solid shape such as a sun. The ink contrasts with the base fabric.

When the fabric is extended across the bars, the gaps widen and the base fabric becomes visible between the bars, so the shape appears striped.

The width of the gaps is selected, for the fabric concerned, so that the striped appearance becomes evident at the predetermined extension.

VARIATIONS

The following variations are within the scope of the invention, alone or in combination:

1. Location across the shoulders, chest or upper back.
2. A contrasting colour or a word revealed in the gaps.
3. Use on swim leggings, sun sleeves and sports tops.

The embodiments described are examples only. Features of one embodiment may be combined with features of another.

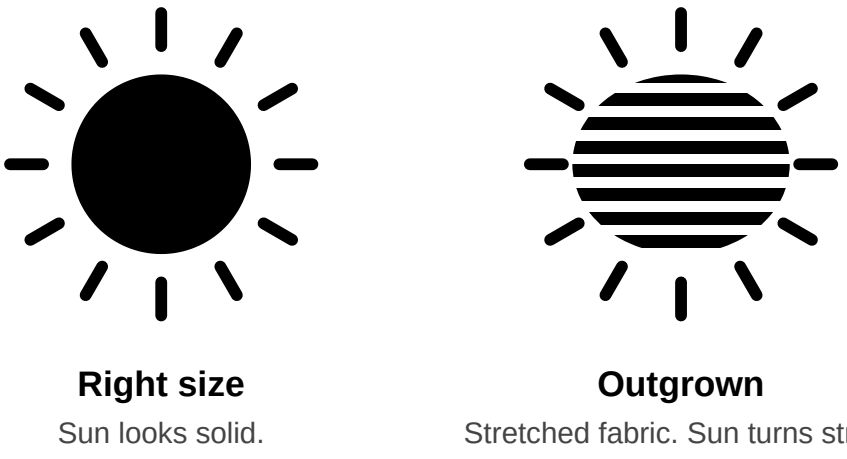

Figure 1